

Hackyard Build 2026 – Complete Details

1. At a Glance

- **Event:** Hackyard Build 2026, presented by Hackyard Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
- **Format:** 24-hour in-person hackathon (Round 1 was an online idea round)
- **Dates:** 24–25 October 2026
- **Venue:** IIT Guwahati, Guwahati, Assam 781039
- **Applicants:** 4,090+ builders applied
- **Selected:** up to 300 builders / projects (limited by safe venue capacity)
- **Theme:** none. AI is optional. Build what should exist.
- **Team size:** solo, or 2–4 people (maximum 4)
- **Minimum age:** 13+ (Devpost listing). Render credits need age 16+.
- **Entry fee:** none. A participant fee covers food and stay (see section 3).
- **Cash pool:** up to ₹4,47,500. Credits are separate.
- **Contact:** hello@hackyard.org
- **Social:** X @joinHackyard | LinkedIn: joinhackyard | Instagram: the.hackyard
- **Eligibility (Devpost):** ages 13+; open to all countries and territories except standard exceptions
- **Tags:** Beginner Friendly, Open Ended, Low/No Code
- **Organizer:** Hackyard Technologies Pvt. Ltd. (public event)

2. Selection Status

- **Result:** Scoop was selected for the in-person round (email from hello@hackyard.org, 8 Oct 2026, signed by Shyamol Konwar, Co-founder & CEO).
- **Selection basis:** projects were reviewed on technical depth, originality and how well they solve a real problem.
- **Team code:** issued in the selection email. Keep it private and do not post it.
- **Selected-builder benefits:** badge, featured profile, shareable Build 2026 credential, project showcases, future event access, and a possible referral of top projects to investors in Hackyard's network.

3. What To Do Next (Seat Confirmation)

- **Fee:** ₹2,500 per person. It covers only stay and food on campus.
- **Deadline:** pay and submit the payment form by **Monday, 12 October 2026, 11:59 pm IST**.
- **Every member** of a team pays and submits the form separately.
- **Form needs:** team code, UTR / UPI reference, payment screenshot.
- **Seats:** a team's seats are confirmed once every member is verified. Unpaid seats move to the waitlist after the deadline. Verification can happen after the deadline.
- **Payment account details** are in the selection email. Pay only to that account and check them against the official result page: hackyard.org/build2026/result.
- **If a teammate cannot attend:** email hello@hackyard.org before the deadline.
- **Builder kit** (on the result page): an official letter for college leave / On-Duty status and travel support, plus social media graphics and a caption.

What the ₹2,500 covers

- 2 nights' stay at IIT Guwahati (24 and 25 October)
- 5 meals: lunch and dinner on 24 Oct; breakfast, lunch and a special dinner on 25 Oct

Refund policy

- Full refund until 18 October
- 50% refund until 21 October
- No refund after that
- Seats are transferable
- Details: hackyard.org/build2026/refunds

Minors

A minor must not assume that selection alone confirms physical attendance. They must complete the guardian-consent and emergency-contact steps Hackyard provides before attendance is confirmed. Do not make non-refundable travel plans until Hackyard confirms selection and attendance details.

4. Key Dates

Date	What happens
14 Sep – 10 Oct 2026	Applications open (online, free)
10 Oct 2026, 11:45 pm IST	Applications and Devpost idea round close
8 Oct 2026	Selection emails sent
12 Oct 2026, 11:59 pm	Payment and form deadline
18 Oct 2026	Last day for a full refund
21 Oct 2026	Last day for a 50% refund
24–25 Oct 2026	24-hour in-person build at IIT Guwahati
Within 30 days after the event	Nodus Challenge cash paid
After the event	Main-event and project cash distributed

Arrival time, check-in details and what to bring will be sent once your seat is confirmed.

5. Venue and Logistics

- **Free:** event entry, build space, internet, power access
- **Paid by you:** food and accommodation (₹2,500 package above)
- **Not covered:** travel to and from IIT Guwahati
- **Bring:** laptop, charger, ID required for check-in, and anything specific to your build that the rules permit
- **Also provided:** builder kit, merch, snacks, Wi-Fi, certificate
- **Final onsite guide** (rest areas, security, medical support, prohibited items, internet and power backup plans) goes to selected builders before the event
- **Accessibility support:** email hello@hackyard.org with the subject "Build 2026 accessibility"
- **Conduct or safety concerns:** email hello@hackyard.org with the subject "Build 2026 conduct". For an immediate onsite risk, contact event staff or venue security.
- **Photos and video:** Hackyard says it will distinguish application consent from any event photo, video or showcase consent

- **Cancellation or changes:** do not buy non-refundable travel until attendance is confirmed

6. How the Event Works

1. **Apply** (14 Sep – 10 Oct): bring an idea, problem or skill. No finished product or pitch deck needed.
2. **Get selected:** the Hackyard Program Team reviews applications and contacts selected builders.
3. **Team up:** find your people and prepare.
4. **The build** (24–25 Oct): build, ship and show.
5. **Keep building:** get seen, get opportunities.

Teams are formed by connecting individual applications with one private team code (format like HYB-XXXXX). Every teammate applies individually.

7. Judging

- **Build, 40%:** Does the working prototype actually work? Functionality, completeness, execution, quality of the demo.
- **Problem, 20%:** Does it solve a real or meaningful problem?
- **Ingenuity, 20%:** Is the approach clever, original or thoughtful?
- **Potential, 20%:** Is there a reason to keep building after the event?

Round 1 (online) ideas were reviewed for problem relevance, innovation, feasibility, impact and execution potential. Judges must disclose conflicts and must not score a project where impartiality is compromised.

The Round 1 Devpost submission asked for four things:

- The problem: what problem you noticed and who is affected
- Your idea: what you would build and how it might solve the problem
- Why it matters: why it is worth building and what impact it could have
- How you might start: a brief approach or the skills you would bring (a prototype or public work link was optional)

No finished product, demo video, source-code repository or pitch deck was needed. The build itself is not due on Devpost.

Judges (Round 1, online):

- Shubham Kumbhalkar, Software Development Engineer II, Amazon
- Ujwal Suresh Vanjare, Infrastructure & Cloud Engineer, BNSF Railway

Round 2: panel to be announced. Agent37 sits on the joint panel for main-event prizes, and a Nodus representative joins the final panel for the Nodus Challenge.

Demo tips from the guide

- Start small: one person, one problem, one useful flow
- Show the problem, then the working flow
- Say what you built, what depends on an external service, and what still needs work
- Test with realistic and awkward inputs, not only the happy path
- Use synthetic, public or authorized data
- Show what the product does, not only what it could do

8. Rules Summary

- Pre-existing libraries, tools and project foundations may be used if disclosed.
- Judging focuses on work created or materially advanced during the official 24-hour build window.
- Open source, AI, APIs, hardware and datasets are allowed when you have the right to use them and disclose important dependencies.
- Do not use stolen credentials, private datasets without permission, or prohibited content.
- Full text: hackyard.org/build2026/rules. Code of Conduct: hackyard.org/build2026/conduct.

8. Founder Sessions

- **Pranav Varshney**, Co-Founder, Nodus Compute (YC F26): "From Google & Uber to YC". Remote session, 20–30 minute talk plus 10 minutes Q&A. He interned at Google, Uber, AWS and Scale AI before starting Nodus.
- **Maria Gorskikh**, Co-Founder & CEO, Maritime (YC F26): from a hacker community to agent infrastructure. Date to be announced.
- **Anirudha Kulkarni**, Founder & CEO, ByteAsk: from a top IIT offer to Silicon Valley.

- **Tejas Gupta**, Co-Founder, Clean (YC F26): named in the selection email.

9. Quick FAQ

- **Is it free to apply?** Yes. Applications were free and open to everyone.
- **Is a finished product needed?** No. The online round took ideas, problems or skills.
- **Can I join alone?** Yes. Solo, in a 2–4 person team, or looking for teammates.
- **Do I need to be a developer?** No. Designers, researchers, founders and operators are welcome.
- **Does selection guarantee a prize?** No. Prizes depend on the build and on each partner's terms.
- **Who gets the \$100 LLM credits?** Every selected project gets one allocation, shared if it is a team